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Job

A blameless man who lost everything, wrestled honestly with God, and met him in the whirlwind.

Job lived in the land of Uz, rich, respected and devoted to God. In a single day he lost his flocks, his servants and all ten children; then sores covered his body. Three friends insisted he must have sinned. Job refused their answer, poured out grief and hope, and demanded a hearing with God. God spoke out of a whirlwind, not explaining the suffering but showing his wisdom in creation, and Job bowed in trust. God said Job, not his friends, had spoken rightly, and restored him. The book shows how to hold on to God in the dark.

At a glance

Name	Hebrew <i>Iyyov</i> ; meaning uncertain
Home	The land of Uz; location uncertain, perhaps near Edom
Described as	"Perfect and upright" (Job 1:1)
Family	Seven sons and three daughters, twice (Job 1:2; 42:13)
Friends	Eliphaz, Bildad, Zophar; later Elihu (Job 2:11; 32:2)
Lifespan	Lived 140 years after his trials (Job 42:16)
Main passages	Job 1–2; 19; 38–42
New Testament	James 5:11; 1 Corinthians 3:19 quotes Job 5:13

"Naked came I out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD."

Job 1:21, KJV

The life of Job

Scripture gives no date or author for Job. Many place him in the age of the patriarchs; others date the book's writing much later. Chapters 3–42:6 are poetry framed by prose.

In Uz	● A blameless man Job is the greatest man of the east. He offers burnt offerings for his ten children in case they have sinned. <i>Job 1:1–5</i>
The first test	● Loses everything Satan asks, "Doth Job fear God for nought?" In one day Job loses wealth and children, yet he worships. <i>Job 1:6–22</i>
The second test	● Struck with sores His wife says, "Curse God, and die." He answers, "shall we receive good at the hand of God, and shall we not receive evil?" <i>Job 2:1–10</i>
Seven days	● Friends sit in silence Eliphaz, Bildad and Zophar sit with him seven days and nights, and no one speaks. <i>Job 2:11–13</i>
The long debate	● Job answers his friends They insist suffering comes from sin. Job protests his innocence yet hopes: "I know that my redeemer liveth." <i>Job 3:1–31:40</i>
A younger voice	● Elihu speaks Elihu argues that God uses suffering to warn and teach, and is always just. <i>Job 32:1–37:24</i>
Out of the whirlwind	● God answers "Where wast thou when I laid the foundations of the earth?" Job repents in dust and ashes. <i>Job 38:1–42:6</i>
Afterward	● Prays and is restored Job prays for his friends, and the LORD gives him twice as much as before. <i>Job 42:7–17</i>

Key activities

In Job 1–2 the Hebrew calls Job's accuser "the satan," meaning "the adversary." Most Christians identify him with Satan; some scholars see an accusing angel in God's court. Christians also differ over the book's date and whether it is history, poetry based on real events, or both.

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- I Lived with integrity.** He feared God and turned away from evil, and God himself called him blameless. *Job 1:1, 8*

 - 2 Prayed for his children.** He regularly offered sacrifices for them, in case they had sinned in their hearts. *Job 1:5*

 - 3 Worshipped in loss.** He tore his robe, fell to the ground and said, "blessed be the name of the LORD." *Job 1:20–22*

 - 4 Held on in pain.** He would not curse God: "In all this did not Job sin with his lips." *Job 2:9–10*

 - 5 Grieved honestly.** He cursed the day of his birth and poured out his anguish before God. *Job 3:1–26*

 - 6 Refused false comfort.** He called his accusing friends "miserable comforters." *Job 16:1–5*

 - 7 Clung to hope.** "For I know that my redeemer liveth, and that he shall stand at the latter day upon the earth." *Job 19:25–27*

 - 8 Trusted God's refining.** "When he hath tried me, I shall come forth as gold." *Job 23:10*

 - 9 Defended his life.** He described how he had helped the poor, the fatherless and the widow. *Job 29:11–17; 31:16–22*

 - 10 Humbled himself before God.** "I have heard of thee by the hearing of the ear: but now mine eye seeth thee." *Job 42:5–6*

 - 11 Prayed for his friends.** He prayed for the men who had wronged him, and God accepted his prayer. *Job 42:8–10*

 - 12 Gave his daughters an inheritance.** In a world where daughters rarely inherited, he gave them an inheritance among their brothers. *Job 42:13–15*

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Job.

Old Testament

Job 1–42	The main account
Ezekiel 14:14, 20	"Noah, Daniel, and Job" as righteous men
Echo: Proverbs 1:7	Fear of the Lord as wisdom, as in Job 28:28
Echo: Psalm 73; Habakkuk 1	Why do the righteous suffer?

New Testament

James 5:11	"Ye have heard of the patience of Job"
1 Corinthians 3:19	Paul quotes Eliphaz's words in Job 5:13
Echo: John 9:1–3	Blindness not proof of sin
Echo: Hebrews 7:25	Job's living redeemer answered in Christ
Tradition	The Talmud names Moses as author; the book does not say

For discussion

1. *Observe:* How did Job respond to his first losses (Job 1:20–22), and how did his words change in chapter 3?
2. *Understand:* God said the friends had not spoken rightly (Job 42:7). Why was their answer wrong?
3. *Apply:* The friends did best in silence (Job 2:13). How can you be present with someone grieving?
4. *Apply:* What honest question or complaint do you need to bring to God in prayer?